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Subject: CP - work update, weeks ending 10/17/2008
Date: Friday, October 17, 2008 6:31:03 PM

On my Plate

- EPHT – Portal development
- Lead maps, reporting
 - Water CWG – data, conference calls
 - Enterprise Address Geocoding Tool
 - Asthma/air surveillance
 - Cognos assistance
 - Arsenic in wells mapping project
 - Birth outcomes multi-state project

Lead - address cleaning/geocoding, 2003-2007

Cancer – North Deering inquiry
- geocoding protocol

Program – Arsenic exposure study

ME-CDC – Data Access Workgroup

USM – Meetings, misc.

These weeks' activities

EPHT

Portal development - Data acquisition/compilation/display creation:

- Draft maps of “high density” area EBLs 2003-2007 by Census Blocks
 - Public, censored “1-5” dots [I circulated a sample of a couple]
 - Secure, graduated dots [haven’t shown these]
- these take a lot of time and effort to create, so I hope they will be valuable to the Portal, and that I’m not, like, barking up the wrong tree.

Cognos content – many comments/discussion on Lisa’s Cognos-driven tables/charts/maps. Tried to figure out problem with PH District label positions (no luck).

The Portal (for real! kinda) – Rene introduced me to the local-install demo; I learned

some valuable things about the nature of the content repository beast behind the scenes and how it all works. This led to some more experiments, and to some test content given to Rene, exploring ways to embed PDFs, Cognos reports, and more into the Portal. Déjà vu all over again, but now it has a basis in the live Portal environment.

Side show – mapping using Google Earth plugin: generated simulated data in order to give realistic demo to others

Mapping alternatives – attended brownbag demo of MapServer application. This is going to be MEGIS' lightweight solution for web-serving of maps, at a cost of \$75/month for basic service, \$150/month for service with custom programming; this is compared to \$300/month for the ArcGIS server environment. They will have a standard template which will include the State basemap (the green topographical thing that I've used). It's mostly about display, with no real query and GIS features. More sophisticated stuff could be done, but it would require custom programming. There are no plans to have a secure environment, but probably one server for "outward-facing" public data, and a separate one for "inward" behind-the-firewall delivery. It's a little difficult for me to see where this service fits, because it's a little like doing Google Maps overlays, except the basemap is worse and less flexible. The benefit of MapServer is having a pre-built maine.gov interface and relatively quick'n'easy deployment of multiple layers and whatnot. MapServer is much faster than the old ArcIMS servers (like the EIS thing we've seen) too. Mike Smith says this open source platform is very popular at universities/colleges, so it may quickly grow in sophistication and capability. It will be interesting to see what MEGIS deploys with it.

Roles

Uh, I still haven't provided comments on Rene's draft document.

Water CWG – no developments.

Address Geocoding Tool – had feedback/development session with Mike F. on interface and functionality for batch interface. As usual, some oddities, and some encouraging things. On the up side, it sounds like it would be no problem for him to generate a KML file from the output, which people could use to immediately map the results with Google Earth (no ArcGIS required!).

Asthma/Air Surveillance – no developments.

Birth Outcomes multi-state analysis – no developments.

Arsenic in wells mapping project – no developments.

Other EPHT – no developments.

Lead

Lead Epi interviews – a couple more applications; no new interviews.

Cancer

North Deering inquiry – Noted some rumblings from last cancer meeting, but I haven't been pulled in yet.

Geocoding protocol – Nothing new.

CO surveillance

Analysis contract – Had phone conference with Lee Friedman, helped to deliver data securely.

Program

Arsenic Exposure Study – Noted Toenail Soaking Study Protocol.

MHDO data issue – Meeting with Cindy Mervis, Lisa, and Kathy. I was impressed that the problem is worth pursuing until its resolved, though at the level of most analyses the impact may be modest. I am also impressed by Lisa and Cindy's attention to data quality as much as I am depressed by MHDO's lack thereof.

ME-CDC

Data Workgroup – no news.

USM

Meetings, goings-on – no activity of late.

Deadlines

Demo Maps for Portal – gave some to Rene.
Text, reports, etc. for Water– 12/1.

Time spent:

- 80% - EPHT Portal-related (includes Lead)
- 5% - Lead support/data request (maps for Naomi)
- 5% - Lead Epi candidate evaluation/interviews
- <5% - Water CWG: data generation, conference calls
- 5% - Geocoding Tool development

5% - ME-CDC, MHDO, etc. meetings

<5% - this update

<5% - USM meetings